

Mp10 Web — Printing

Encounter forms and labels from the browser, and the helper behind them

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1 About this guide

Mp10 Web prints encounter forms and labels on the **printer attached to the workstation you are sitting at**, using the same templates as the desktop application — so a label printed from the browser and a label printed from Mp10 come out identical.

It does that through a small companion program, **MpPrintSrv**, installed on each workstation that prints. This guide has three parts:

- **Using it** — for the person at the front desk. No setup.
- **Installing it** — for whoever looks after the computers. Marked **IT task**.
- **When something is wrong** — a fault-finding table, and the one trap that catches most installations.

1.1 Why there is a separate program at all

Three reasons, and they are worth knowing because they explain every other decision in this guide:

1. **The printer is chosen by name from the workstation's own printer list.** Label printers sit at the desk, so the printing has to be started at the desk. A web server in a rack cannot see them.
2. **The report templates bind to the database in a way only Mp10's own toolchain can reproduce.** MpPrintSrv is built from the same code as the desktop application, which is what guarantees the output matches.
3. **The templates live in the database**, not in files on disk, so there is nothing to copy to each workstation and nothing that can drift out of date.

2 Using it

2.1 Printing an encounter form or a label

On either Encounters grid — the standalone **Encounters** list, or a patient’s own **Encounters** tab — select the encounter, then choose:

- **Print encounter** — the encounter form, to the workstation’s FORMS printer.
- **Print label** — the encounter label, to the workstation’s LABELS printer.

The printer is chosen automatically. Nothing asks you which one.

2.2 Preview — checking before you spend a label

Preview produces exactly what would have been printed, as a PDF in a new browser tab, without sending anything to a printer.

Use it when you want to check a form looks right, when a label came out wrong and you want to see whether the problem is the data or the printer, or when somebody just wants to read what is on the encounter.

It is the same template and the same data as printing — not an approximation.

If nothing opens, your browser has blocked the new tab. Allow pop-ups for this site; Mp10 Web tells you when this has happened rather than appearing to do nothing.

2.3 Printing claims

The **Print** button on the Claims dialog is wired up but not finished: it reports that claim printing is still to be built. Print claims from the desktop application in the meantime.

2.4 What it does not do

Designing and editing the report templates stays in the desktop application. That is deliberate, not an oversight — a template is shared by everyone, and editing one is a deskbound job. There is no way to reach it from a browser.

3 When something is wrong

Every failure is reported in the page with a message that names the cause. Nothing is ever printed silently or half-printed.

What it says	What it means	Who fixes it
No printer whose name contains LABELS (<i>or FORMS</i>) is installed on this workstation	The printer is missing, misnamed — or the helper is a service that cannot see it. See <i>The session 0 trap</i>	IT task
The print helper is not answering on this workstation	MpPrintSrv is not running here, or its allowed-origins setting does not list this site	IT task
Encounter not found	The encounter number did not match a record	Check the encounter
A print job stopped responding at (<i>time</i>) ... needs restarting	A job hung; the helper has stopped accepting new ones on purpose	Admin → Print helper , then Restart
The print job did not finish within 60 seconds	Same as above, reported to whoever was waiting	As above
Claim printing is not built yet	Expected — see above	—
Report design is a desktop function	Expected — see above	—
<i>An update was applied but nothing changed</i>	The service is still running the old program	Restart it, then check the Build line

The message “*The print helper is not answering*” covers two different problems on purpose: **a browser cannot tell them apart**. When a page is refused by the helper’s origin list, the browser blocks the reply before Mp10 Web can read the explanation, and it looks exactly like nothing listening. Check both.

3.1 Admin → Print helper

Users with the `system.printhelper` permission get an **Admin** → **Print helper** page. It reports on the helper running on **whichever workstation has the browser open** — sitting at a different desk shows you that desk’s helper.

It shows:

- **State** — whether it is answering, **which build it is running**, whether it is installed as a Windows service, which account it runs as, and when it started.
- **Jobs** — how many have printed, how many failed, and the last error.
- **Printers this helper can see** — which printer it would pick for FORMS and for LABELS, and the full list. **This is the page that solves most printing problems.**
- **Allowed origins** — the addresses it will accept requests from.

And a **Restart** button.

3.1.1 When to use Restart

Use it when the page reports that a job **stopped responding**. The helper deliberately refuses further jobs after that rather than queueing them behind a job that is never going to finish, and a restart is what clears it.

The button only works when MpPrintSrv was installed as a Windows service. A copy that somebody started by hand can only be stopped, and the page says so rather than leaving you waiting for a comeback that is not coming.

A restart takes a few seconds. The page waits for a genuinely new instance before it tells you it worked — not merely for something to answer, because the old copy keeps replying for a moment after being asked to stop.

4 Installing it — IT task

4.1 What to copy

From the Mp10 installation folder, onto each workstation that prints — **four files**:

File	What it is
MpPrintSrv.exe	the helper itself
FrSystH.dll	the report engine that renders the templates
ace32.dll	the Advantage database client
Mp10.ini	settings — copy Mp10.ini.example and edit it

ace32.dll is the one that gets forgotten, because on a PC that already runs the Mp10 desktop applications it is there already and nobody notices. On a workstation that only ever uses the browser it is **not**, and without it MpPrintSrv.exe will not start at all.

4.2 1. Settings

Two settings matter, both in Mp10.ini next to the program:

[RDD]

RDD-VERSION=REMOTE

PATH=\\adsserver\adsdata\sfi\

[PRINT]

PORT=6265

ORIGIN=https://mp10web.example.org

- [RDD] PATH — the folder holding mp.add, the same value the desktop applications use.
- [PRINT] ORIGIN — **the address staff open Mp10 Web at**, exactly as the browser sends it: scheme and host, no trailing slash, and the port too when it is not 80 or 443.

ORIGIN is not a formality. It is the whole of the access control: a page served from any other address is stopped by the browser before its request is ever sent. Get it wrong and **nothing prints**, with the message “*The print helper is not answering*”. Several may be listed, comma separated, which is what a site reachable over both http and https needs.

PORT is 6265 on both sides. Changing it here means changing it in Mp10 Web’s build as well, so leave it alone unless something else on the workstation already wants that port.

4.3 2. Name the printers

The printer is found **by name**. This is the same convention the desktop application already uses:

- the label printer’s Windows name must contain **LABELS**
- the form printer’s Windows name must contain **FORMS**

Case does not matter. Zebra ZD410 LABELS and labels-front-desk both work.

4.4 3. Install the service

From an **elevated** command prompt, in the folder holding MpPrintSrv.exe:

```
MpPrintSrv.exe -i
```

It starts immediately, and again at every boot. The other verbs:

Command	What it does
<code>MpPrintSrv.exe -i</code>	Install and start
<code>MpPrintSrv.exe -u</code>	Stop and remove
<code>MpPrintSrv.exe -start</code>	Start
<code>MpPrintSrv.exe -stop</code>	Stop
<code>MpPrintSrv.exe -restart</code>	Stop and start
<code>MpPrintSrv.exe -status</code>	Report the service state
<code>MpPrintSrv.exe -listen</code>	Run in the foreground instead, without installing

Install also configures Windows to restart the service automatically if it ever crashes.

All of these need an elevated prompt. Without one, `-status` reports “*unknown (needs an elevated prompt to ask)*” rather than guessing.

4.5 4. The session 0 trap

Read this one even if everything appears to work.

A Windows service runs in what Windows calls *session 0*, and **session 0 cannot see printers that a signed-in user added**. Since `MpPrintSrv` picks its printer by name out of that list, the result is:

No printer whose name contains LABELS is installed on this workstation

which sounds like a naming mistake and is not. The printer is installed. The service simply cannot see it.

Two fixes, either is fine:

- **Install the printers for the whole machine** rather than for one user; or
- **Run the service as a user** who has them:

```
MpPrintSrv.exe -u
MpPrintSrv.exe -i -account=DOMAIN\user -svcpwd=secret
```

To tell which situation you are in, open **Admin** → **Print helper** on that workstation. It names the account the service runs as and lists every printer that account can see. If the account is `SYSTEM` and the list is missing the label printer, this is your problem.

4.6 5. Check it

Without a browser, from the folder holding the program:

```
MpPrintSrv.exe -enc=<an encounter number> -what=label -mode=pdf -out=c:\temp\t.pdf
```

A PDF means the database connection, the template and the data are all working, and **only the printer is left to sort out**. That single command separates half the possible faults from the other half.

Then, from a browser on that workstation, select an encounter and choose **Preview**, then **Print label**.

4.7 6. Updating a workstation later

Stop the service before copying, and start it afterwards.

Copying a new `MpPrintSrv.exe` over a running service *looks* like it worked — the copy succeeds, with no error and no warning — but the service goes on running the **old** program until it is restarted. Measured: with one build running and a newer one already on disk, the service still reported the older one, and only a restart changed it.


```
MpPrintSrv.exe -stop
... copy the new files ...
MpPrintSrv.exe -start
```

Then open **Admin** → **Print helper** on that workstation and check the **Build** line. It reports the build the helper is *actually running*, not the one sitting in the folder — which is exactly the question worth asking after an update, and the only way to catch a workstation that was missed.

4.8 7. Where to look when it misbehaves

MpPrintSrv.log, beside the program, records every job and every refusal with a timestamp — what was printed, which template, and what went wrong. It is the first thing to read and usually the last thing you need.

5 Notes for the curious

5.1 Is it safe to have a program listening on the workstation?

It listens on 127.0.0.1 only — the loopback address — so nothing else on the network can reach it, only software already running on that PC. On top of that it accepts requests only from the web addresses listed in [PRINT] ORIGIN; your browser enforces that before a request is ever sent.

This is the same arrangement the practice already relies on for signature pads, where Topaz's SigWeb runs the same way on each workstation.

5.2 What happens if a print job hangs

The helper is built so that a stuck job cannot take the rest of it down with it. Printing runs separately from the part that answers Mp10 Web, so **Admin** → **Print helper** keeps working and keeps reporting — which is what makes the **Restart** button useful at the moment you actually need it.

After sixty seconds a job is declared stuck: whoever was waiting is told, and further printing is refused with a message naming the time it happened, rather than silently queueing work that will never come out.

5.3 Does an https site really reach a http://127.0.0.1 helper?

Yes. Browsers treat the loopback address as trustworthy and exempt it from the usual rule against mixed content. SigWeb depends on the same behaviour.